

IranScape – Website Development Documentation

1. The idea of the website

IranScape is a mainly a travel and blog website that I created to present Iran, its natural landscapes, historical locations and cultural heritage. I also created a personal blog page to write about my own stories and personal travel experiences. My main goal was to create a visually beautiful, modern and useful website for foreigners or anyone who doesn't speak Persian to learn about the most beautiful locations from a person who is from there and has many experiences. My website is a combinations of information of locations as well as my own stories and personal experiences.

My intention for the website is to attract international people as much as possible, and I would like to add more blogs and destinations in the future. I also have two more coming features which are "Travel agency and hotel finder" and "AI Photo analyzer". I am going to add these two features in the future which have more complexity and give my website more functionality.

2. Planning and Visual Design

I initially developed the visual design using Figma. I used the Figma design as a directions for the structure, typography, spacing, colors and overall appearance of the website.

The visual design uses a light and warm background together with darker text. I chose Montserrat for navigation and body text and Playfair Display for larger headings and decorative typography.

This combination was used throughout the different pages to create a consistent visual design. So, all the pages of the website could match with each other.

The main layout was planned around a simple navigation bar, large introductory headings, image-based content sections and clearly separated content areas.

3. Technologies

The website was developed using standard web technologies:

- HTML: for the structure and content of the pages
- CSS: for the visual design, layout, typography, spacing, responsiveness and animations
- JavaScript: for interactive elements and dynamic behaviour
- Google Fonts: for the selected typography
- GitHub Pages: for hosting and publishing the website online

I did not used any website-building platform or template system to create the main structure. The pages were developed directly and manually using HTML, CSS and JavaScript coding in Visual Studio.

4. Development of the needed folders and the Home Page

I first started by creating and opening a folder named “ final project”. Inside this folder, I creates index.html, style.css, and script.js files for the home page, and also subfolders for each of the other pages of the website. What I designed on the home page (the visual style) was later used across the other pages.

The home page contains the main navigation, a large introductory section and a call-to-action leading visitors to the destinations section. The layout was created to give the visitor an immediate visual introduction to the website.

The CSS was used to reproduce the spacing, alignment, typography and colors from the original design. I also added visual interaction to the page using JavaScript, including a gentle reveal effect for content and navigation/headline interactions.

5. Images and File Organization

The website contains many images of locations and my own photographs for the the blog posts. To keep the project organized, images were stored in separated “images” folders.

The final project structure was divided into separate page folders:

final project/

|— index.html

|— style.css

|— script.js

|— images/

|

|— Destination page/

| |— index.html

| |— destinations.css

| |— script.js

| |— images/

|

|— Blog page/

| |— index.html

| |— blog.css

| |— blog.js

| |— images/

|

```
| — Travel Agencies & Hotels/  
| | — index.html  
| | — agency.css  
|  
| — AI analyzer page/  
| | — index.html  
| | — ai.css
```

This structure separates the different sections of the website while keeping them within one main project.

6. Development of the Destinations Page

After completing the home page, I created a separate destinations page. The page was designed to present multiple locations in Iran in individual content frames. Each destination is presented with an image on the left and descriptive information on the right. I separated the frames visually to make each destination easier to distinguish.

The location information also includes links related to Google Earth in order to provide easy access to locations on map, and a better realistic experience. If any location is on the UNESCO World Heritage Sites's list, I have also written it down in the information section. All Images were organized into a image folder, while the HTML, CSS and JavaScript files were kept together in the destinations page folder.

7. Development of the Blog Page

The next major section was the travel and photography blog.

The blog is a personal travel diary rather than as a formal tourism information page. I wrote the entries in a first-person style based on different places and travel experiences, including location names like Alisadr Cave, Namakabrud, Ramsar, Darband and Mashhad.

The page was structured into separate blog entries containing images and written descriptions. CSS was used to create the page layout, typography and spacing, and JavaScript for a reveal effect so that blog sections appear progressively as the user scrolls. The blog therefore adds a more personal dimension to the website.

8. Development of the Travel Agencies & Hotels Page

Because of the limited time, I created the Travel Agencies & Hotels page as a simple "Coming Soon" section.

The purpose of this page was to keep the planned website structure, while maintaining the same visual identity as the other pages. I am going to use a database, and include a search bar, so that the user can search for best rating travel agencies and hotels in each city to help them better plan for their trips. I reused the same typography, background, navigation style and overall spacing.

9. Development of AI photo analyzer Page

Similarly, because of the limited time, I created the AI Photo Analyser page as part of the planned website structure. Users can upload their photos on this webpage, and the page is programmed to analyze the photos using AI (Google Gemini) and to offer recommendations regarding their possible locations or regions in Iran. This feature can be particularly useful for people interested in photography. I reused the same typography, background, navigation style and overall spacing to keep the page consistent with the rest of the website.

10. JavaScript and interactions

JavaScript was used selectively rather than for every part of the website.

One of the main uses was creating reveal effects for content sections. The website uses an Intersection Observer so that certain sections become visible when they enter the user's viewport. This creates a subtle sense of movement while keeping the website relatively minimal.

I separated JavaScript separated from the HTML and CSS through individual .js files for the different pages. This keeps the project organized and makes it easier to modify individual pages independently.

11. Responsive Design

I used CSS media queries to adjust the navigation, typography, spacing and content layout for tablets and mobile devices. For smaller screens, I reduced the navigation spacing and font sizes to make them smaller on smaller screens. Content sections were also adjusted so that the website remains readable and usable. This is important because the original desktop design cannot be resized for its application on mobile devices. It had to be adjusted to different screen sizes.

12. Testing and Iteration

After creating each page, I tested the layout in the browser and adjusted the CSS and HTML based on how the result looked compared with the intended design.

Relative paths were used to connect pages and their resources. I also checked the links between the different pages so that visitors can navigate through the website. This process was especially important because many visual decisions could only be evaluated after seeing the actual website in the browser.

13. Final Organization and Publication

After developing the individual pages, the project was organized into one main folder so that all pages belong to the same website, and I can upload it to a repository.

The website was prepared to be published using GitHub Pages, allowing the final static website to be accessible online directly from the GitHub repository.

14. Reflection on the Development Process

In general, I enjoyed working on my project. Developing this website helped me to use and apply my HTML, CSS and JavaScript knowledge, and even learn more in a complete project rather than only in isolated exercises. Two of the main challenges during my developing process was creating the database and the search bar for the Travel Agency and Hotel page, and also using Google Gemini's API key, the server and connecting it to my web page. I worked on developing the backend, but because the limited time, I couldn't finish it.

Overall, the project developed from a visual concept into a multi-page website with a consistent design system, responsive layouts, organized content and interactive elements. The process also helped me understand how the structure, styling and behaviour of a website work together in a complete web project.